For the time being, for all conventional purposes, choose Perspective View (the other option being Top View) and choose metric centimetres as the preferred System of Units. Since we are just getting acquainted with the interface, these settings don't really affect us much now. They can be modified later on to suit your preferences by going to the Menu Bar and choosing `Window > Preferences > Template`.

Starting with an inspiring "You can learn Google SketchUp", the Learning Centre is a very handy beginner's guide, which opens up every time you start Google SketchUp (unless disabled, of course). From basic introductory suggestions as on how to use Google SketchUp to handy tips and tricks (along with a bit of good old-fashioned advice—on how one should NOT run around with scissors), the Learning Centre is an ideal introduction to Google SketchUp. It also contains a clickable step-by-step interactive model which you can practice on. This *Fast Track* to Google SketchUp is, of course, the better option, since it contains a more detailed explanation for beginners.

The first time you begin Google SketchUp, the Instructor (which can also be activated on later usage by clicking on `Window > Instructor` on the Menu Bar) which is basically a demonstrative guide on the usage of the tool selected, will also be present.

Upon closing both windows, do not be startled if you encounter an individual (called Bryce) who offends both your sense of dressing and 3D logic (you'll realise what we mean later). His pitiful existence is merely to provide you with a good perspective view of the models you create.

You will initially notice three mutually perpendicular lines in bright primary colours (red, blue, and green) serving as the three axes. Any point in three-dimensional space can be uniquely identified with respect to its perpendicular distance from the three axes. This forms the fundamental of all 3D geometry. 3D space is divided into 8 octants. To visualise this easier, take a sphere (or a cube) and make three mutually perpendicular cuts passing through its centre. It will be divided into eight identical parts. Each of these pieces is referred to as octants. You may choose to draw your structures in a combination of any of the eight octants.